that this challenge can be overcome through the adoption of bi-directional contract testing, a topic we'll delve into further in chapter 11.

Remember, introducing any new testing activity or tool requires patience, persistence, and clear communication. Engage your team members, address their concerns, and make sure to highlight the advantages of contract testing, but also be transparent about the challenges that come with contract testing.

2.6 A practical guide on introducing contract testing to projects

At this point, let's say you have a solid foundation on what contract testing is and have also successfully convinced your teams to try out contract testing. You understand the theory behind contract testing, but you still want a how-to guide to get started. Where to start, which tool to choose, and how to get there aren't always straightforward, especially if you don't already have much experience in contract testing. To help you lay out the plan for your contract testing journey, we've come up with the following high-level guide to help you incorporate contract testing into your existing and/or new projects:

- Research what tools to use.
- Identify your consumers and providers.
- Define the contract.
- Write a basic consumer and provider test.
- Add contract testing to your continuous integration/continuous delivery (CI/CD) pipelines.

2.6.1 Research what tools to use

There are a few tools that you can use to implement contract testing, which we'll cover in chapter 3, section 3.6. It's important to research how each tool can help you solve a problem rather than choosing a tool based on its popularity and adoption. While we focus on Pact in this book, it might be worthwhile to research other contract testing tools to see if they fit your